DECODER

1–9

MASTER SPECIAL POINTS DECODER

Every Special-Point Category, Cumulative, Tiered A/B/C

Five Shu · Yuan · Luo · Back-Shu · Front-Mu · Xi-Cleft · He-Sea · Confluent · Command · Hui-Meeting

TIER A
Dr. Zhang's confirmed final-exam review emphasis -- know cold

TIER B
Quiz-tested (Quiz 1-6) and/or high clinical yield -- know well

TIER C
Classical/reference material -- lower priority per Dr. Zhang's Week 9 statement

This is NOT the weekly Study Guide -- it is organized BY POINT CATEGORY, not by channel.

Use it to cross-check: "what are ALL the Yuan-Source points?" instead of "what is LU's Yuan-Source?"
Every category is cross-referenced back to the per-channel ID cards in the Final Study Guide.

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Tier Legend -- Quick Recap

TIER A — Dr. Zhang's confirmed final-exam review emphasis -- know cold

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SPECIAL POINT CATEGORY DEFINITIONS

Read this page FIRST -- every table after assumes you know these terms

Five Shu (Transport) Points	A set of 5 points on each of the 12 primary meridians, located distal to the elbows/knees, through which Qi is said to flow like water: Jing-Well (emerges) -> Ying-Spring (flows) -> Shu-Stream (pours) -> Jing-River (travels) -> He-Sea (enters). Each stage has a distinct clinical application (first aid, febrile disease, joint pain, externally-contracted disease, and Fu-organ disorders, respectively).
Yuan-Source Point	The point where a channel's "Source Qi" (Yuan Qi) is most concentrated and accessible -- effectively the primary tonification/regulation point for that channel's associated organ. On Yin channels it coincides with the Shu-Stream point; on Yang channels it is a separate 6th point.
Luo-Connecting (Luo) Point	The point where a small branch ("Luo-vessel") splits off from the main channel and runs to its internally-externally paired channel, physically linking the two. Used to treat either channel from one point, and clinically significant for chronic/deficiency patterns of the paired organ.
Back-Shu (Transport) Point	One of 12 points on the Bladder channel's inner back line, each directly overlying/associated with a specific Zang-Fu organ. Back-Shu points are the most direct route to influence an organ's Qi from the body's posterior surface -- used heavily in both diagnosis (palpation tenderness) and treatment.
Front-Mu (Alarm) Point	A point on the chest or abdomen, on the front of the body, most closely associated with a specific Zang-Fu organ -- often located near that organ's physical location. Front-Mu points are especially useful for ACUTE organ disorders and, like Back-Shu points, are diagnostically tender on palpation.
Xi-Cleft (Accumulation) Point	A point where a channel's Qi and Blood pool or "accumulate" more deeply than usual. The go-to point category for ACUTE, often painful presentations of that channel's pathology -- acute pain, acute bleeding, or acute spasm -- distinct from the more chronic focus of He-Sea points.
He-Sea (Uniting) Point	The point nearest the elbow or knee where a channel's Qi is said to converge/"enter" most fully, like a river reaching the sea. Classically used for disorders of the Six Fu (hollow) organs and for rebellious/reversed Qi (e.g., vomiting, diarrhea).
Lower He-Sea Point	A special subset of He-Sea points specifically for the 6 Fu organs, located on the leg. Three Fu organs (ST, GB, BL) use their own He-Sea point; the other three (LI, SI, SJ) BORROW a point on a different Foot channel entirely -- a frequently-tested distinction.
Confluent (Opening) Point	One of 8 points on the 12 primary meridians that each "open" (activate) one of the 8 Extraordinary Vessels. Confluent points are the ONLY way to access an Extraordinary Vessel's function through needling, since the vessels themselves (except GV/CV) have no points of their own.
Command Point	One of a small classical set of points (the Four Command Points/Si Zong Xue) each said to "command" -- have outsized therapeutic reach over -- an entire body region (abdomen, back, face/mouth, head/nape), regardless of where the specific complaint is located within that region.
Hui-Meeting (Influential) Point	One of 8 points, each governing a broad tissue/substance category (Qi, Blood, Bone, Marrow, Sinew, Vessels, and the Zang or Fu organs as groups) rather than a single channel or organ -- used when a condition affects that category broadly, cutting across multiple channels.

Crossing (Meeting) Point

A point where two or more channels physically intersect or run together for a stretch. A crossing point can be needled to influence every channel that passes through it, not just the channel it's numbered under -- explaining why some points (e.g. GV14, SP6) show up in multiple channels' pathology.

FIVE SHU (TRANSPORT) POINTS -- 60-POINT MASTER TABLE

TIER A

A specific group of 5 points on each of the 12 primary meridians, situated distal to the elbows/knees: Jing-Well ("where it emerges", tips of fingers/toes, first aid/resuscitation), Ying-Spring ("where it flows", before MCP/MTP, febrile disease), Shu-Stream ("where it pours", after MCP/MTP, heaviness & joint pain), Jing-River ("where it travels", forearm/lower leg, externally-contracted disease), He-Sea ("where it enters", near elbow/knee, disorders of the six Fu).

Split into two narrower tables so neither requires horizontal scrolling on a phone or tablet.

Jing-Well -> Ying-Spring -> Shu-Stream

Meridian	Jing-Well	Ying-Spring	Shu-Stream
Lung (LU)	LU11 Shaoshang	LU10 Yuji	LU9 Taiyuan
Large Intestine (LI)	LI1 Shangyang	LI2 Erjian	LI3 Sanjian
Stomach (ST)	ST45 Lidui	ST44 Neiting	ST43 Xiangu
Spleen (SP)	SP1 Yinbai	SP2 Dadu	SP3 Taibai
Heart (HT)	HT9 Shaochong	HT8 Shaofu	HT7 Shenmen
Small Intestine (SI)	SI1 Shaoze	SI2 Qiangu	SI3 Houxi
Bladder (BL)	BL67 Zhiyin	BL66 Zutonggu	BL65 Shugu
Kidney (KI)	KI1 Yongquan	KI2 Rangu	KI3 Taixi
Pericardium (PC)	PC9 Zhongchong	PC8 Laogong	PC7 Daling
San Jiao (SJ)	SJ1 Guanchong	SJ2 Yemen	SJ3 Zhongzhu
Gallbladder (GB)	GB44 Zuqiaoyin	GB43 Xiaxi	GB41 Zulinqi
Liver (LR)	LR1 Dadun	LR2 Xingjian	LR3 Taichong

Jing-River -> He-Sea

Meridian	Jing-River	He-Sea
Lung (LU)	LU8 Jingqu	LU5 Chize
Large Intestine (LI)	LI5 Yangxi	LI11 Quchi
Stomach (ST)	ST41 Jiexi	ST36 Zusanli
Spleen (SP)	SP5 Shangqiu	SP9 Yinlingquan
Heart (HT)	HT4 Lingdao	HT3 Shaohai
Small Intestine (SI)	SI5 Yanggu	SI8 Xiaohai
Bladder (BL)	BL60 Kunlun	BL40 Weizhong
Kidney (KI)	KI7 Fuliu	KI10 Yingu
Pericardium (PC)	PC5 Jianshi	PC3 Quze
San Jiao (SJ)	SJ6 Zhigou	SJ10 Tianjing
Gallbladder (GB)	GB38 Yangfu	GB34 Yanglingquan

Meridian	Jing-River	He-Sea
Liver (LR)	LR4 Zhongfeng	LR8 Ququan

Yin meridians have NO separate Yuan-Source point -- the Shu-Stream point IS the Yuan point (e.g. Taiyuan LU9 is both Shu-Stream and Yuan for Lung; Taixi KI3 for Kidney). Yang meridians have a 6th, separate Yuan-Source point beyond the 5 Shu points (e.g. Chongyang ST42, Hegu LI4).

YUAN-SOURCE POINTS -- ALL 12 MERIDIANS

TIER A

LU	LU9 Taiyuan	**BL**	BL64 Jinggu
LI	LI4 Hegu -- FORBIDDEN in pregnancy	**KI**	KI3 Taixi (also Shu-Stream -- dual role)
ST	ST42 Chongyang	**PC**	PC7 Daling
SP	SP3 Taibai	**SJ**	SJ4 Yangchi
HT	HT7 Shenmen	**GB**	GB40 Qiuxu
SI	SI4 Wangu	**LR**	LR3 Taichong

On YIN channels, the Yuan-Source point IS the Shu-Stream point (dual role, same point). On YANG channels, Yuan-Source is a separate 6th point beyond the 5 Shu points.

LUO-CONNECTING POINTS -- ALL 15

TIER A

Luo Point	Connection	Note
LU7 Lieque	LU -> LI	also opens Ren Mai (Week 7)
LI6 Pianli	LI -> LU	closest pairing around the wrist to LU7
ST40 Fenglong	ST -> SP	#1 phlegm point in TCM
SP4 Gongsun	SP -> ST	also opens Chong Mai
HT5 Tongli	HT -> SI	1 cun above wrist crease
SI7 Zhizheng	SI -> HT	5 cun above wrist
BL58 Feiyang	BL -> KI	7 cun above external malleolus
KI4 Dazhong	KI -> BL	posterior to internal malleolus
PC6 Neiguan	PC -> SJ	also opens Yin Wei Mai
SJ5 Waiguan	SJ -> PC	also opens Yang Wei Mai
GB37 Guangming	GB -> LR	5 cun above external malleolus
LR5 Ligou	LR -> GB	5 cun above internal malleolus
CV15 Jiuwei	Ren Mai collateral	spreads over the FRONT midline/abdomen
GV1 Changqiang	Du Mai collateral	spreads over the BACK midline
SP21 Dabao	Great (Major) Collateral of Spleen	covers the LATERAL chest -- why there are 15, not 12

Connecting (Luo) points of HAND meridians cluster around the WRIST. Connecting points of FOOT meridians cluster around the ANKLE/MALLEOLUS. CV/GV/SP-Great-Luo are the exceptions, covering front midline, back midline, and lateral chest respectively.

BACK-SHU POINTS -- ORGAN TRANSPORT SERIES (BL13-BL28)

TIER A

Point	Organ Treated
BL13 Feishu	Lung
BL14 Jueyinshu	Pericardium
BL15 Xinshu	Heart
BL18 Ganshu	Liver
BL19 Danshu	Gallbladder
BL20 Pishu	Spleen
BL21 Weishu	Stomach
BL22 Sanjiaoshu	San Jiao
BL23 Shenshu	Kidney
BL25 Dachangshu	Large Intestine
BL27 Xiaochangshu	Small Intestine
BL28 Pangguangshu	Bladder

All 12 Back-Shu points sit on the Bladder channel's inner line, 1.5 cun lateral to the spine -- roughly in organ order top-to-bottom. BL20 (Spleen) and BL21 (Stomach) sit directly adjacent and are a classic confusable pair.

FRONT-MU POINTS -- ALL 12 MERIDIANS

TIER A

LU	LU1 Zhongfu (own -- unusual)	**BL**	CV3 Zhongji
LI	ST25 Tianshu (on ST channel)	**KI**	GB25 Jingmen
ST	CV12 Zhongwan	**PC**	CV17 Danzhong
SP	LR13 Zhangmen (on LR channel)	**SJ**	CV5 Shimen
HT	CV14 Juque	**GB**	GB24 Riyue (own)
SI	CV4 Guanyuan	**LR**	LR14 Qimen (own)

Front-Mu points are scattered across several channels (CV, ST, LR, GB) rather than clustered on one channel like Back-Shu -- the classic Front-Mu exam trap is assuming a point sits on its own channel (e.g. ST25 is Front-Mu of LARGE INTESTINE, not Stomach).

XI-CLEFT POINTS -- ALL 12 MERIDIANS

TIER B

LU	LU6 Kongzui	**BL**	BL63 Jinmen
LI	LI7 Wenliu	**KI**	KI5 Shuiquan
ST	ST34 Liangqiu	**PC**	PC4 Ximen
SP	SP8 Diji	**SJ**	SJ7 Huizong
HT	HT6 Yinxi	**GB**	GB36 Waiqiu
SI	SI6 Yanglao	**LR**	LR6 Zhongdu

Xi-Cleft points are the go-to for ACUTE presentations of that channel's pathology (acute pain, acute bleeding, acute spasm) -- contrast with He-Sea points, used more for chronic/Fu-organ disorders.

HE-SEA POINTS -- ALL 12 MERIDIANS

TIER B

LU	LU5 Chize	**BL**	BL40 Weizhong (Command, back)
LI	LI11 Quchi	**KI**	KI10 Yingu
ST	ST36 Zusanli	**PC**	PC3 Quze
SP	SP9 Yinlingquan	**SJ**	SJ10 Tianjing
HT	HT3 Shaohai	**GB**	GB34 Yanglingquan (also Hui-Meeting Sinews)
SI	SI8 Xiaohai	**LR**	LR8 Ququan

LOWER HE-SEA POINTS -- THE 6 FU ORGANS

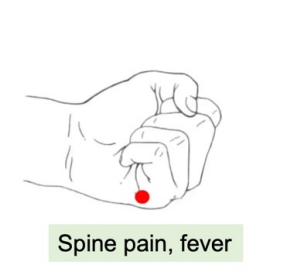
TIER B

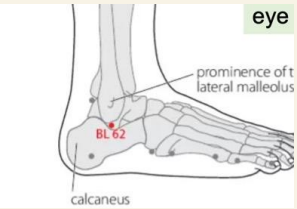
Point	Fu Organ	Use
ST37 Shangjuxu	Large Intestine	LI bowel disorders (diarrhea, appendicitis-type pain)
ST39 Xiajuxu	Small Intestine	SI bowel disorders, lower abdominal pain
BL39 Weiyang	San Jiao	water metabolism, edema, lower back/leg pain
ST36 Zusanli	Stomach (own)	master tonic, digestion, immunity
GB34 Yanglingquan	Gallbladder (own)	also Hui-Meeting of Sinews -- tendons, hypochondriac pain
BL40 Weizhong	Bladder (own)	also Command Point of the back

The 6 Fu (hollow) organs each have a Lower He-Sea point on the leg. ST, GB, and BL simply use their own He-Sea point (already Fu channels). LI, SI, and SJ -- despite being Hand channels -- BORROW a Lower He-Sea point on a FOOT channel (ST or BL) instead of using a point on their own pathway. This is a classic exam trap: LI's and SI's Lower He-Sea points are NOT on the LI or SI channel at all.

EIGHT CONFLUENT POINTS -- OPEN THE 8 EXTRAORDINARY VESSELS

TIER A





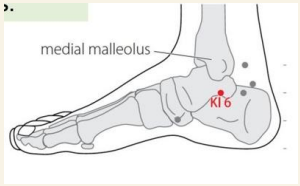
SI3 Houxi + BL62 Shenmai

Opens: Du Mai + Yang Qiao Mai

Use: posterior body, spine, neck, febrile disease

Classic combination for acute spinal rigidity and neck stiffness -- SI3 is also the Shu-Stream point of SI, giving it a dual mechanism for pain along the whole posterior line.



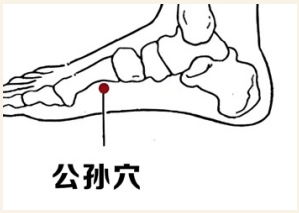


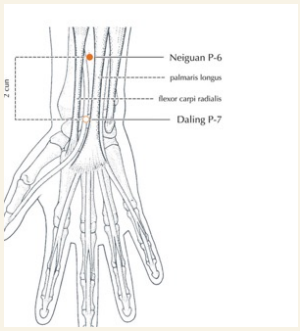
LU7 Lieque + KI6 Zhaohai

Opens: Ren Mai + Yin Qiao Mai

Use: throat, chest, lung, insomnia

LU7 is also LU's Luo-Connecting point; KI6 is the vessel's own confluent gateway. Together they treat throat-chest disorders with an insomnia/restlessness component -- classic for Yin-deficiency insomnia.



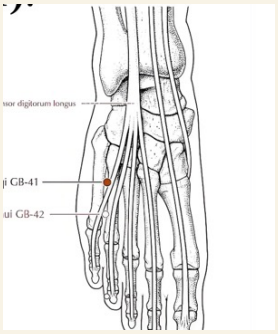


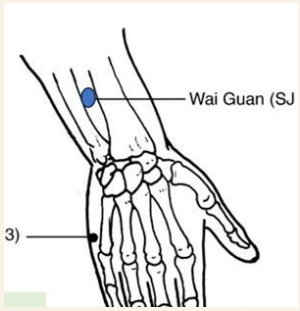
SP4 Gongsun + PC6 Neiguan

Opens: Chong Mai + Yin Wei Mai

Use: chest, heart, stomach -- MOST-used pairing in clinic

The single most clinically-used confluent pair. Both points are ALSO their own channel's Luo-Connecting point, so this combination doubles up on Luo + Confluent mechanisms simultaneously.





GB41 Zulinqi + SJ5 Waiguan

Opens: Dai Mai + Yang Wei Mai

Use: lateral body, hypochondriac pain, exterior disorders

Both are Shaoyang-channel points (same-name channel rule), reinforcing the lateral-body, alternating-fever-and-chills clinical picture shared by Dai Mai and Yang Wei Mai.

FOUR COMMAND POINTS (SI ZONG XUE)

TIER B

Point	Governs Region	Note
ST36 Zusanli	Abdomen	the #1 tonic point in TCM; He-Sea + Lower He-Sea of ST
BL40 Weizhong	Back	He-Sea of BL; "aspirin of acupuncture"
LU7 Lieque	Head / Nape	Luo of LU; also Confluent point opening Ren Mai
LI4 Hegu	Face / Mouth	Yuan-Source of LI; FORBIDDEN in pregnancy

The Four Command Points (Si Zong Xue) -- a classical mnemonic distinct from, but often confused with, the 8 Confluent Points. "Command" points treat a whole body REGION; Confluent points open an Extraordinary Vessel. Some points (LU7, LI4) do double duty as both a Command point AND part of another special category -- always check whether a question is asking about regional command or vessel confluence.

EIGHT HUI-MEETING (INFLUENTIAL) POINTS

TIER C

Point	Governs	Use
CV12 Zhongwan	Fu (Hollow) Organs	digestive disorders, all six Fu organs
LR13 Zhangmen	Zang (Solid) Organs	organ-level disharmony, hypochondriac pain
CV17 Danzhong	Qi	chest Qi stagnation, breathing, lactation
BL17 Geshu	Blood	all blood disorders -- bleeding, stasis, deficiency
BL11 Dazhu	Bone	bone disorders, also a classic exterior-releasing point
GB39 Xuanzhong (Juegu)	Marrow	marrow, brain, spinal cord, also relates to bone marrow
GB34 Yanglingquan	Sinew (Tendon)	tendons/ligaments, also He-Sea of GB and Lower He-Sea of GB
LU9 Taiyuan	Vessels (Pulse)	all pulse/vessel disorders, also Yuan-Source of LU

The 8 Hui-Meeting (Influential) Points are classical CAM/MOA reference material -- each governs a tissue/substance category rather than a single channel. Not explicitly confirmed as part of Dr. Zhang's live review, but standard course-textbook material worth recognizing (Tier C).

CROSSING (MEETING) POINTS -- BY CHANNEL

TIER C

Channel	Count	Note
ST	11	mostly on the face/head -- LI20, BL1, GB3/4/6, SP1, GV24, GV26, CV12/13/24
BL	14	shared specifically with GV and Gallbladder, concentrated around the head
GB	12	across 6 meridians (SJ, LR, PC, SI, ST, GV) -- confirmed against the 2026 slide deck
SJ	10+	shares crossing points with GB around head/ear/shoulder, plus GV14, SI12
SP	6	abdomen/chest region -- CV3, CV4, CV10, GB24, LR14, LU1
LR	6	shared with CV (2) and SP (1) around the genital/abdomen region
SI / LI	few	crosses GV14 and the cheek/eye/shoulder region
HT / PC	0	the ONLY 2 primary channels with ZERO named crossing points -- classic paired trap

Per Dr. Zhang's Week 9 review, deep crossing-point memorization is lower priority than the pathway and special-point material above -- know the notable counts (ST=11 most, HT/PC=0) rather than every individual crossing point.

CROSS-REFERENCE INDEX -- ONE RECORD PER CHANNEL

Every category, in narrow record format -- no horizontal scrolling

LU -- Lung

Yuan: LU9 Taiyuan · Luo: LU7 Lieque · Xi-Cleft: LU6 Kongzui · He-Sea: LU5 Chize · Back-Shu: BL13 Feishu · Front-Mu: LU1 Zhongfu (own -- unusual) · Confluent/Cmd: LU7 -- opens Ren Mai (paired w/ KI6)

LI -- Large Intestine

Yuan: LI4 Hegu -- FORBIDDEN in pregnancy · Luo: LI6 Pianli · Xi-Cleft: LI7 Wenliu · He-Sea: LI11 Quchi · Back-Shu: BL25 Dachangshu · Front-Mu: ST25 Tianshu (on ST channel) · Confluent/Cmd: LI4 -- face/mouth

ST -- Stomach

Yuan: ST42 Chongyang · Luo: ST40 Fenglong · Xi-Cleft: ST34 Liangqiu · He-Sea: ST36 Zusanli · Back-Shu: BL21 Weishu · Front-Mu: CV12 Zhongwan · Confluent/Cmd: ST36 -- abdomen; Lower He-Sea ST37 (LI) / ST39 (SI)

SP -- Spleen

Yuan: SP3 Taibai · Luo: SP4 Gongsun · Xi-Cleft: SP8 Diji · He-Sea: SP9 Yinlingquan · Back-Shu: BL20 Pishu · Front-Mu: LR13 Zhangmen (on LR channel) · Confluent/Cmd: SP4 -- opens Chong Mai (paired w/ PC6)

HT -- Heart

Yuan: HT7 Shenmen · Luo: HT5 Tongli · Xi-Cleft: HT6 Yinxi · He-Sea: HT3 Shaohai · Back-Shu: BL15 Xinshu · Front-Mu: CV14 Juque · Confluent/Cmd: none

SI -- Small Intestine

Yuan: SI4 Wangu · Luo: SI7 Zhizheng · Xi-Cleft: SI6 Yanglao · He-Sea: SI8 Xiaohai · Back-Shu: BL27 Xiaochangshu · Front-Mu: CV4 Guanyuan · Confluent/Cmd: SI3 Houxi -- opens Du Mai (paired w/ BL62)

BL -- Bladder

Yuan: BL64 Jinggu · Luo: BL58 Feiyang · Xi-Cleft: BL63 Jinmen · He-Sea: BL40 Weizhong (Command, back) · Back-Shu: BL28 Pangguangshu (own) · Front-Mu: CV3 Zhongji · Confluent/Cmd: BL62 Shenmai -- opens Yang Qiao Mai (paired w/ SI3)

KI -- Kidney

Yuan: KI3 Taixi (also Shu-Stream -- dual role) · Luo: KI4 Dazhong · Xi-Cleft: KI5 Shuiquan · He-Sea: KI10 Yingu · Back-Shu: BL23 Shenshu · Front-Mu: GB25 Jingmen · Confluent/Cmd: KI6 Zhaohai -- opens Yin Qiao Mai (paired w/ LU7)

PC -- Pericardium

Yuan: PC7 Daling · Luo: PC6 Neiguan · Xi-Cleft: PC4 Ximen · He-Sea: PC3 Quze · Back-Shu: BL14 Jueyinshu · Front-Mu: CV17 Danzhong · Confluent/Cmd: PC6 -- opens Yin Wei Mai (paired w/ SP4) -- most-used confluent pairing in clinic

SJ -- San Jiao / Triple Energizer

Yuan: SJ4 Yangchi · Luo: SJ5 Waiguan · Xi-Cleft: SJ7 Huizong · He-Sea: SJ10 Tianjing · Back-Shu: BL22 Sanjiaoshu · Front-Mu: CV5 Shimen · Confluent/Cmd: SJ5 -- opens Yang Wei Mai (paired w/ GB41)

GB -- Gallbladder

Yuan: GB40 Qiuxu · Luo: GB37 Guangming · Xi-Cleft: GB36 Waiqiu · He-Sea: GB34 Yanglingquan (also Hui-Meeting Sinews) · Back-Shu: BL19 Danshu · Front-Mu: GB24 Riyue (own) · Confluent/Cmd: GB41 Zulinqi -- opens Dai Mai (paired w/ SJ5)

LR -- Liver

Yuan: LR3 Taichong · Luo: LR5 Ligou · Xi-Cleft: LR6 Zhongdu · He-Sea: LR8 Ququan · Back-Shu: BL18 Ganshu · Front-Mu: LR14 Qimen (own) · Confluent/Cmd: none directly (LR13 is the SP Front-Mu; LR14 is LR's own Front-Mu)